

The Foundational Principles of Morality and You.

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What is Morality?

Refers to the quality of human acts by which we call them right or wrong, good or evil. (Panizo, 1964)

Human action is right when it conforms with the norm, rule, or law of morality.



Panizo, 1964

Meaning of Foundational Moral Principle

The word principle came from the Latin word, “princeps” which means “a source or beginning.”

A principle is, that on which something is based, founded, originated or initiated.

A foundational moral principle is, therefore, *the universal norm* upon which all other principles on the rightness or wrongness of an action are based.

It is the source of morality.

Where is this foundational moral principle?



It is contained in the natural law.



Many moralists, authors, and philosophers may have referred to this foundation moral principle in different terms.



May be acceptable to believers and non-believers alike to refer to it as natural law.

What is the natural law?

- ▶ “It is the law written in the hearts of men.” (Romans 2:15)
- ▶ For theists, it is “man’s share in the Eternal Law of God...” (Panizo, 1964)
- ▶ St. Thomas defines it as “the light of natural reason, whereby we discern what is good and what is evil... an imprint on us of the divine light...” (Panizo, 1964)
- ▶ It is the law that says: “Do good and avoid evil.”

This is the
Foundational
Moral
Principle



All men and women, regardless of race and belief, have a sense of this foundational moral principle. It is ingrained in man's nature.



“It is built into the design of human nature, and woven into the fabric of the normal human mind.”

We are inclined to do what we recognize is good, and avoid that which we recognize is evil.

- Our act is moral when it is in accordance with our human nature.
- Our act is immoral when it is contrary to our human nature.
- Our intellect and free will, make us different from and above the beast.



The natural law that says
“do good and avoid evil”
comes in different versions.

▶ “Do not do to others what you do not like others to do to you.”

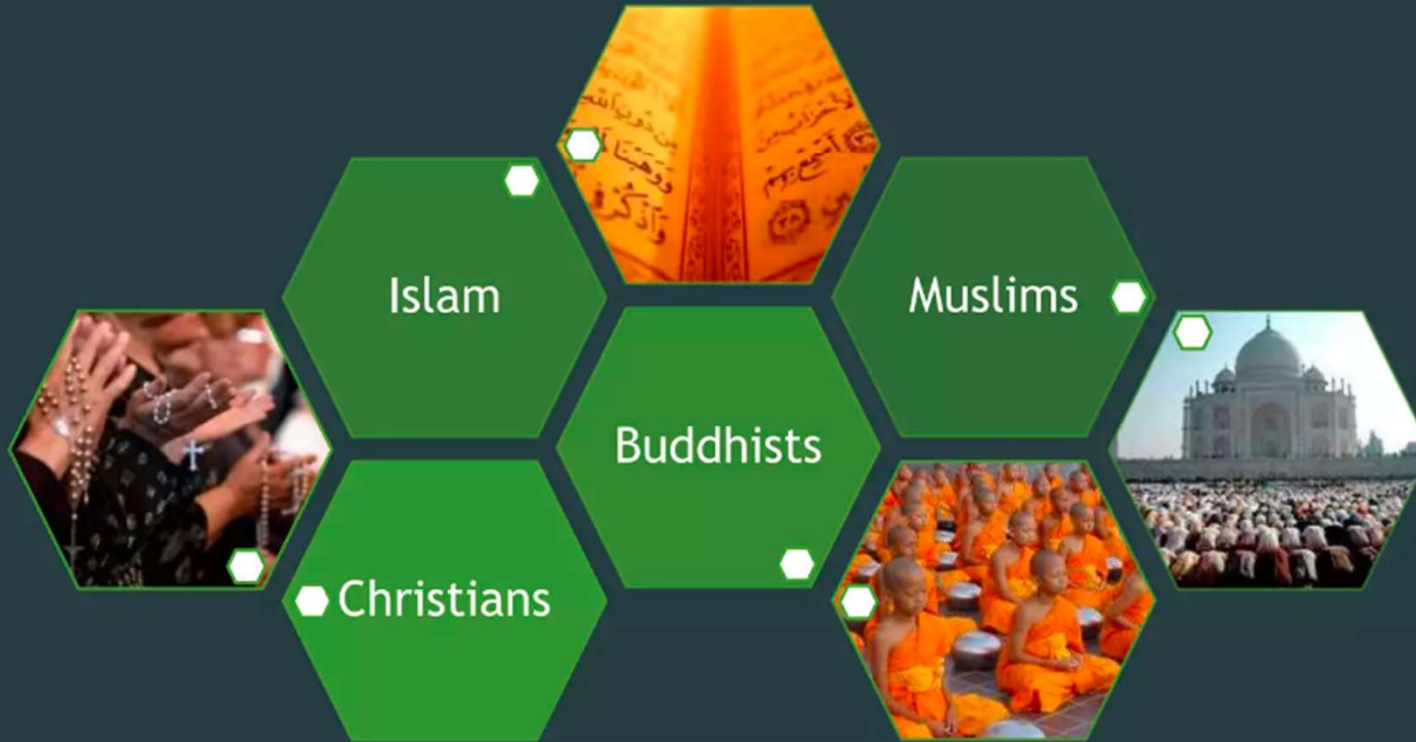
- Kung Fu Tsu

▶ “Do to others what you want them to do to you.”

- Golden Rule of Christianity

▶ “Act in such a way that your maxim can be the maxim for all.”

- Immanuel Kant



Christians, Buddhists, Islamic Korans and Muslims

RELIGIOUS VIEWS ON MORALITY.

Christian's Perspective:

“Do to others what you want them to do to you.”

This golden rule is made more explicit through the Ten Commandment and the Eight Beatitudes. These are summed up in the two great commandments:

- “Love God with all your heart, with all your mind, with all your strength” and
- “Love your neighbor as you love yourself.”

Buddhists' Perspective

“Hatred does not cease by hatred; hatred ceases only by love.”

The Buddhists state this through the eight-fold path. For them, they do good when they:

- Strive to know the truth
- Resolve to resist evil
- Say nothing to hurt others
- Respect life, morality and property
- Engage in a job that does not injure others
- Strive to free their mind of evil
- Control their feelings and thoughts
- Practice proper forms of concentrations

Islamic Perspective Based on the Islamic Quran

The Islamic Quran
“forbids lying,
stealing, adultery
and murder.”

It also teaches
“honor for parents,
kindness to slaves,
protection for the
orphaned and the
widowed and
charity to the poor.

It teaches the
virtues of faith in
God, patience,
kindness, honesty,
industry, honor,
courage and
generosity.

It condemns
mistrust,
impatience and
cruelty.

Muslims' Perspective

The Five Pillars of Islam

Muslims
abide
by the
Five
Pillars
of
Islam

Prayer

Self-Purification by Fasting

Fasting

Almsgiving

Pilgrimage to Mecca for those who can afford

Teacher, as a person of good moral character

- ▶ According to the preamble of our Code of Ethics as professional teachers...

“Teachers are duly licensed professionals who possess dignity and reputation with high moral values as well as technical and professional competence. In the practice of their profession, they strictly adhere to, observe and practice this set of ethical and moral principles, standard values.”

4 Ways of Describing Good Moral Character

As described by one Christian author

1. **Being fully human** - you have realized substantially your potential as human person.
2. **Being a loving person** - you are caring in an unselfish and mature manner with yourself, other people and God.
3. **Being a virtuous person** - you have acquired good habits and attitudes and you practice them consistently in your daily life.
4. **Being a morally mature person** - you have reached a level of development emotionally, socially, mentally, spiritually appropriate to your developmental stage.

-Cosgrave, William, rev. ed. 2004,78-79



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Thank you!